

StoryDogs and Learning Standards

New York Next Generation ELA + Common Core • Kindergarten–Grade 6

StoryDogs supports narrative planning: students introduce a character, connect events, make a meaningful choice, and show an ending. The strongest standards connection is narrative writing. A seven-step outline is a starting point; a finished draft and the student's explanation give teachers fuller evidence of learning.

New York teachers should use the NYS Next Generation ELA Learning Standards. Common Core provides a cross-state reference, not a required national curriculum. States and districts determine their requirements and teaching materials. These are suggested instructional connections, not an official endorsement or a claim of complete mastery. [1–3]

New York: find your grade

The middle column summarizes selected expectations. The last column suggests what to teach or collect. All seven StoryDogs steps support the plan. [1]

Grade and NY code	Selected expectation, paraphrased	StoryDogs teaching move / evidence
K • KW3	Tell events in order through drawing, dictation, talk, or early writing.	Scribe the child's words. Ask them to point to what happened first, next, and last.
1 • 1W3	Write about real or imagined events in a short sequence.	Use the oral plan to support a short written story. Collect the student's own writing.
2 • 2W3	Sequence events; include actions, thoughts, feelings, time words, and closure.	Expand one problem with a feeling and action. Add "later" or "next" where useful and an ending.
3 • 3W3a–d	Introduce characters; develop reactions, order, and a conclusion.	WHO and LIFE establish the start. Expand TROUBLE with a thought or feeling; connect it to CHANGE.
4 • 4W3a–e	Develop narrative with dialogue, transitions, sensory detail, and an ending.	Draft a scene from WORSE or CLIMAX. Add purposeful dialogue and one detail a reader can sense.
5 • 5W3a–e	Develop characters and events with narrative techniques, varied transitions, and detail.	Turn the plan into scenes. Make the ending follow from the character's actions.
6 • 6W3a–e	Develop a sequenced narrative; signal time/setting shifts; reflect in the conclusion.	Draft the climax, then show how the ending reflects the experience. Mark any shift in time or place.

For Grades 3–6, WHO/LIFE especially support W3a; linked events support W3c; CHANGE supports 3W3d or 4W3e–6W3e. Dialogue and detailed description require drafting beyond the outline.

Common Core: the cross-state comparison

Common Core State Standards (CCSS) are learning goals, not a national set of lessons. Use this page when your school references CCSS, and check any state-specific revisions. Codes below use the standard CCSS.ELA-LITERACY prefix. [2–3]

Grade and CCSS code	Selected expectation, paraphrased	StoryDogs teaching move / evidence
K • W.K.3	Narrate an event or linked events in order using drawing, dictation, and writing; include a reaction.	Tell or draw the sequence. Ask “How did your character feel about what happened?”
1 • W.1.3	Recount at least two ordered events, with details, time words, and closure.	Write from the outline. Include a detail, a time word, and a final line that finishes the story.
2 • W.2.3	Develop an event or short sequence with actions, thoughts, feelings, time words, and closure.	Expand TROUBLE and WORSE with the character’s reactions. Check event order and the ending.
3 • W.3.3a–d	Set up a situation and characters; use dialogue, reactions, time words, and closure.	Introduce the character and situation, then draft a short scene with speech and a feeling.
4 • W.4.3a–e	Organize events naturally; use dialogue, varied transitions, concrete/sensory detail, and a resulting conclusion.	Turn the steps into a short story. Use a precise action verb and a sensory detail at the big moment.
5 • W.5.3a–e	Develop events and characters through dialogue, description, pacing, transitions, and precise detail.	Slow down CLIMAX into several actions or lines of dialogue; move quickly through less important moments.
6 • W.6.3a–e	Build a logical narrative; use technique, precise detail, transitions across time/settings, and a fitting conclusion.	Draft connected scenes. Make time/place changes clear and keep the ending connected to the events.

Similar goals, different wording

Do not swap New York and Common Core codes automatically. For example, NY 3W3b emphasizes descriptions of actions, thoughts, and feelings; CCSS W.3.3b also explicitly includes dialogue. CCSS W.5.3b names pacing, while NY 5W3b names dialogue and description. [1–2]

A quick check after the activity

Ask the student to explain what caused the next problem and point to the choice that shaped the ending. Then inspect the draft for your grade’s additional expectations. A filled-in worksheet alone does not show how much a student can do independently.

Add a small follow-up to extend the learning

Choose the connection that fits your lesson. These require the teaching move shown; the website alone does not provide the full learning experience.

Connection and codes [1–2]	What the teacher adds	Evidence to notice
Discussion NY: KSL1, 1SL1–6SL1 CCSS: SL.K.1, SL.1.1–SL.6.1	Build a shared story in pairs or a group. Practice taking turns, asking questions, and using a partner's idea. Older students explain how a suggestion changes their plan.	Note one contribution, one response to a peer, and whether each student can explain the group's choice.
Revision NY: Lifelong Practices of Writers CCSS: W.K.5, W.1.5–W.6.5	Give a partner one specific question: "What caused this?" Revise the unclear part. Add age-appropriate editing after the story makes sense.	Keep a before-and-after passage and ask the student to explain the improvement.
Oral storytelling NY: 1SL4–4SL4 CCSS: SL.1.4–SL.4.4	Have students tell their story using pictures or their plan. Rehearse enough detail and a pace/volume listeners can follow.	Listen for an understandable sequence and relevant details. Do not assess confident performance as the only evidence of story skill.
Response to a text NY: 1W4–6W4	After a shared read-aloud, use StoryDogs to imagine a new episode or another character's experience. Discuss the connection to the source.	Collect the response and a brief explanation of which source idea the student developed.

For kindergarten sharing, describe a familiar person, place, object, or event from the plan to practice NY KSL4 / CCSS SL.K.4. For Grades 5–6, simply reading fiction aloud does not cover all SL.4 presentation expectations; those include reporting on a topic/text or presenting claims and findings.

Choose an accessible way to plan: drawing, oral rehearsal, home-language brainstorming, a scribe, or writing. Record the support used. These options help children develop stories; they do not automatically demonstrate independent writing or every language convention.

Ready-to-use lesson-plan statement

"Students will use StoryDogs to plan a narrative with connected events and an ending. They will develop the plan into a grade-appropriate story and revise one part after feedback. Evidence: the plan, the draft, and the student's explanation of one cause-and-effect connection." Add your grade's W3 code above.

Sources and how to use this guide

Standards descriptions are selective paraphrases. Activity matches and teaching moves are StoryDogs instructional suggestions. Consult the full standard and your local curriculum for assessment decisions.

[1] NYSED • Next Generation ELA Learning Standards (2017): W3, SL1, SL4, W4; Lifelong Practices

[2] Common Core • Full ELA standards: Writing pp. 19–21, 43–44; Speaking/Listening pp. 23–24, 49

[3] Common Core • Frequently Asked Questions: standards, curriculum, and state responsibility